

I. INSTRUCTIONS

1. File Naming and Format Requirements

- Submit your project using the provided Microsoft Word (.docx) file. **Do not delete or modify any part of the original file.** Submissions in other formats (ex. PDF, Pages, Google Docs) will not be accepted.
- Please provide your responses in the space marked **“Start writing here”** under each section.
- Save your file using this format:
GROUP_NUMBER_PROJECT (ex. GROUP1_PROJECT).
- Times New Roman, 12 pt, Double-spaced, Pages should be numbered.

- **FILL OUT THE FOLLOWING TABLE:**

No.	Student Name	Student ID	Section Number	Define the parts of the assignment completed by each member of your group
1	Islamov Sarvar	U2210088	003	Step 1 & 2
2	Kalimullin Rinat	U2210099	003	Step 4 & 6
3	Komilov Shovkatjon	U2210122	003	Step 5 & 6
4	Xatamov Javohirbek	U2210251	005	Step 5 & 6
5	Zikirillaev Asadtilla	U2210280	005	Step 3
6				

2. Content, Originality & AI Usage Policy

All work submitted must be your **own original writing**. To maintain academic integrity and ensure fairness for all students, the following rules apply:

- **Do not copy** any material from textbooks, lecture slides, websites, or any external sources.
- **Do not use any AI tool**, including but not limited to:
 - ChatGPT or similar AI writing generators
 - Grammar correction tools (like Grammarly Premium)
 - Paraphrasing tools or synonym changers
 - Translation tools
 - Autocorrect features that produce AI footprints

Your work will be checked for both **plagiarism and AI-generated content**. Even if AI detection tools do not flag your work directly, any submission that appears **illogical, inconsistent or lacking personal voice** may be subject to penalties.

If **AI usage or plagiarism is suspected**, your group will:

- Receive an **initial score of 0** for the project.
- Be required to attend a **defense session in Week 16**, where all group members must be present.
- If the defense is successful, your score may be **partially restored**, but **full points will not be granted** under any circumstances.

BY SUBMITTING THIS ASSIGNMENT, YOU CONFIRM THAT:

- You fully understand and agree to comply with the **Content, Originality & AI Usage Policy**.
- You have **not used any AI-based tools or platforms**, including AI-generated writing, paraphrasing, grammar correction, translation, or similar assistance.
- You acknowledge and accept the **consequences** in case your submission is found to involve AI-generated content or plagiarism, including the possibility of receiving a **score of 0** and being required to attend a **defense session**.

3. Referencing:

- If you use any ideas or facts from external sources, you must provide in-text references.
- You can use any referencing style (APA, MLA, etc), but the source must be clearly indicated within the text.

Example of In-text Referencing:

- According to Robbins and Judge (2022), organizational culture strongly influences employee behavior.
- Leadership plays a central role in shaping culture (Robbins & Judge, 2022).

At the end of the file, you should include all sources that you have included in the text:

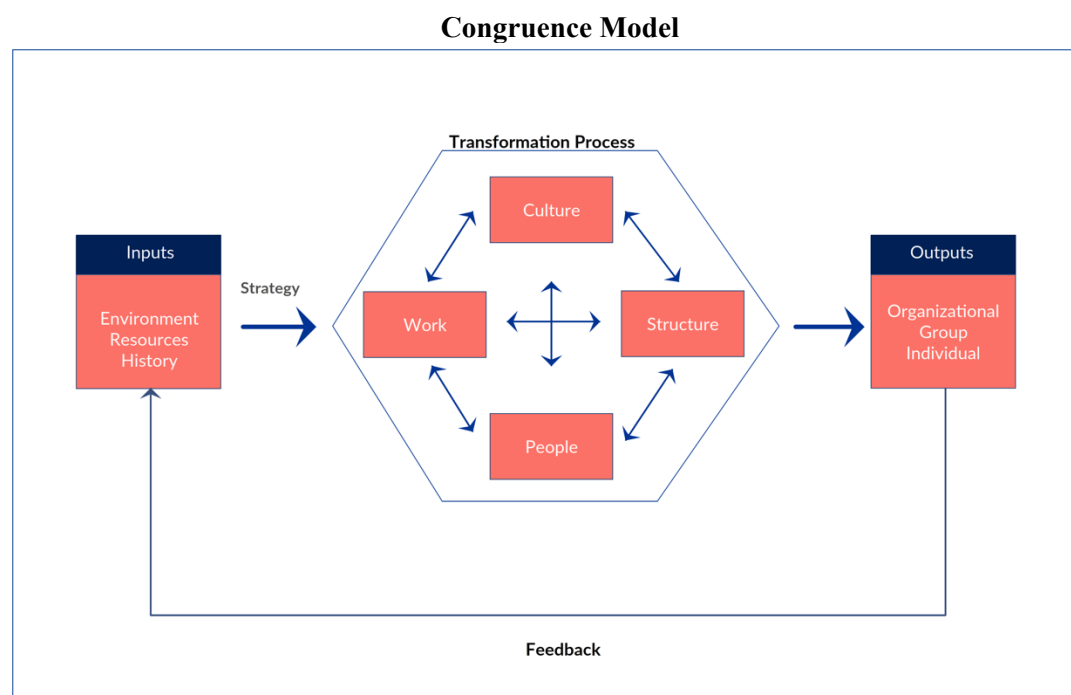
- Robbins & Judge (2022). Organizational Behaviour. Pearson, 12th ed.

Example of Footnoting:

- Organizational alignment is essential for improving overall effectiveness in a company.¹

At the bottom of the page or in the footnote section:

- ¹ Stephen P. Robbins and Timothy A. Judge, Organizational Behavior, 19th ed. (Pearson, 2022), 64.



II. What is the Congruence Model?

The Congruence Model, developed by Nadler and Tushman, is a framework that helps managers analyze how well the different parts of an organization fit together. When these elements are aligned (or congruent), the organization is more likely to perform effectively. Misalignment - or incongruence - can create gaps that hurt productivity and performance.

Why Use It?

The model is useful in identifying:

- **Opportunity Gaps:** when the external environment has changed but the organization hasn't adapted.
- **Performance Gaps:** when the organization is not delivering the outcomes it aims to.

Key Components of the Model

The model focuses on how the organization transforms **inputs** (resources like people, money, materials, etc.) into **outputs** (such as products, services or performance results) through four major internal components:

1. **Work:** The tasks and activities that need to be done to meet goals.
2. **People:** The skills, needs, and motivations of employees.
3. **Formal Organization (Structure):** The structure, rules, processes, and systems that guide work.
4. **Informal Organization (Culture):** Values, norms, behaviors and unwritten rules.

How It Works

Success depends on how well these four components align with one another and with the company's goals and environment. For example:

- If the tasks require innovation but the culture discourages risk-taking, there is a misalignment.
- If employees are highly skilled but the structure limits decision-making, performance may suffer.

When to Use the Congruence Model

1. When performance is not meeting expectations.
2. During periods of change (new leadership, new strategy).
3. To assess readiness for growth or innovation.

Steps for Analysis

1. Understand the **external environment** (using tools like PESTLE or SWOT).
2. Analyze each of the four internal components.
3. Identify where misalignments exist.
4. Propose action steps to realign and improve performance.

III. PROJECT TASK INSTRUCTIONS

You will choose a local company or an international company with a physical presence in Uzbekistan and analyze it using the Congruence Model developed by Nadler and Tushman. You should apply the Congruence Model to a real organization to assess how well its internal components (Work, People, Structure and Culture) align with each other, identify any performance or opportunity gaps and propose realistic improvements.

Your task will include the following steps:

Step 1: Company Background (100 - 150 words)

Briefly introduce the company: name, location, industry, and size.

Start writing here:

OOO “INSANE TECH GROUP” is a Tashkent based company with offices in Oybek street. It is an IT company which is the part of the huge holding named “AX HOLDING”. The holding specializes in selling real estate in Dubai and Abu Dhabi. The OOO “INSANE TECH” which is also referred as “AX TECHNOLOGY”, specializes in the software development for the “AX HOLDING”. In most cases, the software is created to improve the experience of agents working within the company and increase the number of leads¹ or lead generation sources². The company has many teams working on different IT projects. These projects range from creating a simple website or landing page³ to developing an advanced application for Apple Vision Pro.

Step 2: Environmental Analysis (PESTLE + SWOT Table (300 - 350 words): Create a table where you list at least one external factor for each PESTLE category and connect it to a relevant SWOT element. You may use the table provided below or come up with your own table format.

Tip: Use public information, news, or general knowledge.

Keep in mind:

- PESTLE helps you analyze the external environment (Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental).
- SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats) is used to assess internal capabilities and strategic positioning.
- You may use the table provided below or come up with your own table format.

¹ Leads refer to potential customers who have shown interest in the company's products or services.

² Lead generation sources are the methods or platforms through which leads are acquired, such as social media, referrals, or online advertising.

³ Landing page is a single page website

PESTLE Factor	Impact on the Company	Related SWOT Element	Comment / Explanation
Start writing here:			
Political	Corporate tax cuts for IT companies in Uzbekistan lowers the taxes for AX TECHNOLOGY from 15% to 10%	Strength	Lower taxes improve profits (Strength) and free up the budget for hiring the top talent or starting new high risk high return revelational projects (Opportunity).
Economic	Fast real-estate growth in the UAE increases the demand for the properties	Opportunity	As the demand rises the searchers will become more open for new ways to find property, here the AX TECHNOLOGY can use this opportunity to get them as customers.
Social	Over 60% of Uzbekistan's population is under 30	Strength	In case if AX TECHNOLOGY will start expanding it has a massive pool of young, educated workers
Technological	Global shift towards online property shopping	Opportunity	More and more people are using online real estate platforms to find a house, office etc. this means if marketed right, AX TECHNOLOGY has a massive potential to increase its userbase
Legal	Uzbekistan still has gaps in its investing and cross-border money transfer regulations.	Weakness/ Threat	The lack of regulations might scare away potential investors and slow down the company's growth
Environmental	If AX TECHNOLOGY decides to set up their own server in Uzbekistan, there might be little to no regulations but it	Strength/Weakness	Company can set up servers really fast with little number of certifications and check ups and pay really little for maintenance and waste management,

	will likely change in the future		but if Uzbekistan adopts global datacenter ⁴ standards this might result in complete rebuilding of the datacenter which might cost a lot.
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Step 3. Performance or Opportunity Gap Statement (150 - 200 words)

Write a problem or opportunity statement based on your observations.

- A **performance gap** is when the company is underperforming or failing to meet expectations.
- An **opportunity gap** is when the company is not taking advantage of a new idea, technology, or market trend.

Tip: Think about customer complaints, slow processes, low innovation, etc.

Start writing here:

There is no doubt that AX TECHNOLOGY is achieving all its business needs, meaning that the company doesn't experience any serious performance gaps. However, it is clear that AX TECHNOLOGY shows the opportunity gaps, despite having numerous talented employees that push the company forward, the company experiences the lack of well-educated and brilliant minds that are professional in certain fields. This gap is especially noticeable when AX TECHNOLOGY is developing a complex software. When staff that is experienced only in developing simple websites take on a project that requires the employee who has professional knowledge in this field. This opportunity gap results in the losing the possible opportunities that might double its value for the AX HOLDING, which could lead to the raising of the investments and scaling the AX TECHNOLOGY. Without properly addressing the shortage of professionals, AX TECHNOLOGY tends to keep its current scale, diminishing its potential for further growth and opportunities, thus risking itself to stagnate for a continuous time.

Step 4: Analyze the 4 Components of the Congruence Model (400 – 500 words): Describe each of the four components and how they relate to the company's current problem or gap. Use guiding questions:

- **Work:** Are employee tasks clear and aligned with goals?
- **People:** Do employees have the skills, motivation, and support they need?
- **Structure:** How is the company organized? Does it help or block performance?
- **Culture:** What are the common values and behaviors? Do they support innovation and teamwork?

Tip: You can observe, visit, talk to staff or check websites, job ads, LinkedIn profiles, customer reviews, etc.

Start writing here:

⁴ Datacenter is a collection of servers, it might occupy one room or a whole building.

Work:

The main work within the company is to develop the IT products, each product has its own dedicated team which is fully equipped with all necessary specialists ranging from designers and managers to the developers who wrote the code.

People:

The company employed the skilled employees who are bright not only in the hard skills, but also in the soft skills that subsequently created the peaceful and positive atmosphere to work. Nevertheless, most people despite working in the IT field, didn't possess any professional IT education, most of them acquired the online course certificates from the platforms like Udemy and Yandex Practicum.

Structure:

The company followed the top-down hierarchy and was divided into the departments like “Marketing Department”, “Analytical Department” and so on. Moreover, there is numerous evidence that AX TECHNOLOGY experienced cross-department collaboration in an unorganized way. Some managers were surprised when they discovered that their employees were busy with the different projects, assigned by different managers and teams.

Culture:

AX TECHNOLOGY possesses the “efficiency” culture, when being efficient and at the same time effective were highly appreciated by the manager and the C-levels.

Step 5: Identify Misalignments (250 – 300 words)

Now that you’ve completed your analysis of the four key components - Work, People, Structure and Culture - your next step is to identify where the organization may be out of alignment. Misalignment means that two or more components are not working well together, which can lead to inefficiencies, frustration or poor performance. For example, do highly skilled employees feel stuck due to poor structure? Does the culture block creativity?

To help guide your thinking, reflect on the following possible misalignments:

- **People - Structure:** Does the structure (formal organization) allow employees to collaborate effectively and feel supported? Or are there too many layers or communication barriers? Do employees hold clear perceptions of organizational cultures?
- **People - Work:** Are employees’ skills and interests suited to the tasks they are expected to do? Do they have the necessary knowledge, skills and motivation to meet task demands?
- **People - Culture:** Do employees feel comfortable within the current culture? Do their personal values match the organization’s values?
- **Work - Structure:** Is the way the organization is structured (ex. hierarchy, teams, reporting lines) helping or blocking task completion? Are tasks delayed because of unclear responsibilities or poor coordination? Do organizational arrangements motivate behaviour that is consistent with task demand?
- **Work - Culture:** Does the company’s culture support the kind of work it needs to do?

For example, if innovation is important, does the culture encourage risk-taking and new ideas?

- **Structure - Culture:** Is the structure (such as rules, policies, or formality) in line with the values (culture) promoted by the company? Are there tensions between “how things are done” and “what the company claims to value”?

By reviewing these relationships, you can identify specific areas of disconnect and begin thinking about practical changes to better align the organization’s components. Write a short summary identifying at least 2 key misalignments and why they matter.

Start writing here:

1. People - Structure: There is a fundamental disconnect between employees and the organizational structure they operate within. Employees face confusion and frustration due to an excessive number of communication layers, where they receive conflicting tasks from multiple authority figures simultaneously - the local CEO, orders straight from the main CEO, and teams from the main office. The confusing reporting system causes the staff to be uncertain about whose task has a higher priority, creating unawareness and reducing productivity.

2. People - Work: The COO assigns professional titles without employee input or consideration of their actual skills and preferences, resulting in inappropriate position placements. This creates a situation where employees' talents are misaligned with their formal roles, reducing both job satisfaction and effectiveness. The company employs individuals who lack formal IT education beyond basic online courses yet assigns them to develop complex software solutions. This skills gap becomes particularly problematic when staff experienced only in simple website development are tasked with building advanced applications for platforms like Apple Vision Pro. The mismatch between employee capabilities and work requirements prevents the company from delivering high-quality products.

3. Work - Structure: The chaotic hierarchical structure severely affects the effectiveness of a task completion. Departments are often unaware that their teams are receiving direct assignments from the main office, creating increased workload and priority conflicts. There is also always a possibility of unexpected shutdown of departments working on specific features or products which disrupts the trust on the company. This structural instability makes it impossible to establish reliable workflows or project management processes, as teams never know when their priorities might suddenly change or their department might get shut down altogether.

Step 6: Suggest an Action Plan (Recommendations) (350 – 400 words)

Based on the misalignments you identified, propose two to three realistic and meaningful solutions that are directly relevant to the organization you studied. Each solution should be specific and actionable.

For example, instead of simply stating “improve communication,” explain what exactly should be done, such as “implement weekly cross-department meetings with shared digital reports to ensure alignment on tasks and priorities.”

For each solution, briefly explain why this action would address the misalignment and what positive outcomes you expect (ex. increased employee engagement, improved workflow,

reduced role ambiguity). Lastly, connect your solution to at least one theory or model discussed in class. This may include motivation theories (like Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, ...), leadership styles and theories (ex. transformational leadership, Situational leadership Theory, ...), or decision-making and organizational change models (ex. Kurt Lewin's Three Step Model, ...).

For example, if your proposed solution aims to increase employee ownership of tasks, you might write: "This solution reflects the Job Characteristics Model, particularly the dimensions of autonomy and task identity, which contribute to higher motivation and job satisfaction."

Start writing here:

Solution 1: Single, centralized reporting system.

Action Steps:

1. Integrate a task-management platform (e.g. Trello with custom features) into workflow to centralize all task assignments, each task with one owner, a deadline, and a manager's comment.
2. Conduct training sessions to onboard employees, advertising the system's time-saving benefits.
3. Hold weekly backlog-sorting meetings with team leads and the COO to solve priority conflicts.

Monitor the number of priority conflicts via surveys and track missed deadlines to measure efficiency.

Why It Works: Eliminates conflicting tasks from different managers, reducing confusion.

Theoretical Link: Kurt Lewin's Three-Step Change Model— unfreeze chaotic communication, change via the platform, refreeze with performance metrics.

Expected Outcome: 20% reduction in missed deadlines and improved employee clarity within 3 months.

Solution 2: Structured skills matching for a role

Action Steps:

1. Introduce a "fit review" process: online technical quiz, 15-minute expert interview, and self-assessment form for each project role.
2. Automate quizzes via an LMS platform (even google forms is ok); reserve interviews for complex or top hires (e.g. Apple Vision Pro development or top manager).
3. Track the quiz results in the database to use later to create a pool of workers with skill

info.

4. If no fit candidate exists, offer upskilling for current employees via partnerships with IT Park or Coursera.

Why It Works: Matches employee skills with tasks, reducing frustration and rework. Theoretical Link: Job Characteristics Model - enhances skill variety and task identity, boosting intrinsic motivation.

Expected Outcome: 15% increase in job satisfaction and 10% decrease in project rework in 6 months.

Solution 3: Transparent, culture based on trust

Action Steps:

1. Launch monthly “State of AX” forums for the CEO to share strategic plans and address concerns via anonymous Q&A.
2. Develop a layoff policy prioritizing redeployment and 30-day notice.
3. Train managers on supportive leadership to reduce fear-driven work.
4. Pilot in one department, while tracking engagement via surveys.
5. Assess trust and deadlines quarterly.

Why It Works: Transparency and clear policies rebuild trust, stabilizing workflows. Theoretical Link: Psychological Contract Theory—meeting job security expectations boosts commitment.

Expected Outcome: 20% higher trust, 10% better deadlines in 6 months.

IV. EVALUATION RUBRIC and MARK ALLOCATION

Evaluation rubric for the project: Max. 42 points equal to 30%

Criteria	No Submission / Irrelevant	Satisfactory	Good	Excellent
Adherence to Instructions	Did not follow instructions. (0 point)	Partially followed instructions. (1 point)	Mostly followed instructions. (2 points)	Fully followed all instructions. (3 points)
Step 1: Company Background	No submission or irrelevant company background. (0 point)	Basic background given but lacks clarity or relevance. (1 point)	Relevant background provided with some minor gaps. (2 points)	Clear, concise, and relevant company background. (3 points)
Step 2: Environmental Analysis (PESTLE + SWOT)	No analysis or unrelated content. (0 point)	Limited or unclear PESTLE and/or SWOT connections. (1-2 points)	Adequate table with some insightful connections. (3-4 points)	Thorough, relevant, and clearly connected analysis. (5-6 points)
Step 3: Gap Statement	No gap identified or irrelevant statement. (0 point)	Basic gap identified with weak justification. (1 point)	Gap identified with reasonable justification. (2 points)	Clear, relevant, and well-justified gap statement. (3 points)
Step 4: Congruence Model Analysis	No analysis of the 4 components. (0 point)	Superficial or incomplete component analysis. (1-3 points)	Good description of components with some relevance. (4-6 points)	Thorough, insightful analysis of all four components. (7-9 points)
	7 All four components are described with strong relevance. The structure is clearly problematic (uncontrolled reporting lines), and culture is efficiently-focused but possibly rigid. The section captures the essence of the company's internal realities. However, the analysis is still largely descriptive; while each part is discussed, their interdependencies are only implied, not deeply examined. For instance, how the structure directly impacts the clarity of work or trust in culture could be made more explicit. Deeper integration of OB concepts would strengthen the analytical impact.			
Step 5: Misalignment Identification	No misalignments identified. (0 point)	General or unclear identification of issues. (1-2 points)	Relevant misalignments identified and explained. (3-4 points)	Clear, specific, and well-explained misalignments. (5-6 points)
Step 6: Action Plan and	No action plan or vague suggestions.	Basic ideas without strong connection to theory.	Reasonable plan with partial theoretical support.	Actionable recommendations clearly supported by theory.

Theoretical Link	(0 point)	(1-3 points)	(4-6 points)	(7-9 points)
Clarity, Organization, and Format	Disorganized, hard to follow. (0 point)	Some structure but lacks clarity. (1 point)	Mostly clear and organized writing. (2 points)	Clear, well-organized, and professionally presented. (3 points)